

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter School Overview

Louisiana — LSCSC / NLRB R15 Jurisdiction — May 2026

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Section 1: State Overview

State	Louisiana
Labor Board	LSCSC / NLRB R15 — Louisiana State Civil Service Commission (LSCSC) under LERA [Type 1/3/3B/4, locally-authorized]; NLRB Region 15 New Orleans [Type 2/5 BESE-authorized — pre-Act 172 history only]
Governing Law	Louisiana Employee Relations Act (LERA) — post-Act 172 (signed May 23, 2024) for all BESE-authorized Type 2/5 charters. Pre-Act 172: NLRA / NLRB R15. Locally-authorized (Type 1/3/3B/4) charters: LSCSC/LERA throughout.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — NLRB R15 applies to pre-Act 172 history for Type 2/5 BESE-authorized schools only. Post-Act 172 (May 23, 2024): all BESE-authorized charters reclassified as public employers — NLRB R15 affirmed no jurisdiction April 2025, upheld January 2026. Locally-authorized schools (Type 1/3/3B/4): LSCSC/LERA throughout; NLRB does not apply.
Right-to-Work	Right-to-Work State — La. R.S. §23:982 (Louisiana is a right-to-work state. Union security clauses are not available for LA charter school unions. Applies to Type 1/3/3B OPSB-authorized schools under NLRB jurisdiction as private employers. Type 2/5 schools under Act 172 LSCSC routing have no established collective bargaining procedure as of June 2026.)
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	YES — Voluntary recognition (board vote) has been the dominant mechanism in the NOLA charter school community. No card-check statute per se — but board vote recognition produces the same outcome without an adversarial election. LSCSC/LERA does not have an established charter school certification procedure as of May 2026.
Registry Sweep	May 2026 — 139 charter schools searched
Research Window	May 2026 (initial research session)

Section 2: Charter School Landscape

Total charter schools in Louisiana: 139 (Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 138 open LA charter schools as of May 2026). Registry v94 audit June 5, 2026: 134 Open + 4 New + 1 Closing (St. Landry, still operating) = 139 active. 13 Closed schools excluded per census methodology.). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Total Organized Charter Schools in Louisiana	4	2.9%	Active CONFIRMED schools only. All OPSB-authorized (Type 1/3/3B), NLRB Region 15 jurisdiction. Excludes Lycée Français (jurisdiction stripped by Act 172, May 2024) and 1 closed school. Denominator: 138 open LA charter schools (Registry v50).
Independently Organized (CONFIRMED)	4	2.9%	Morris Jeff (2013), Benjamin Franklin HS (2014), Bricolage Academy (2021). All UTNO/AFT Local 527. All OPSB-authorized (Type 1/3/3B). All active CBAs.

Certified — Jurisdiction Stripped by Act 172 (LEGISLATIVE_STRIP)	1	0.7%	Lycée Français de la Nouvelle-Orléans — NLRB cert May 21, 2024; Act 172 (signed May 23, 2024) stripped NLRB jurisdiction. NLRB R15 Regional Director ruled April 1, 2025 that LFNO is a political subdivision exempt from NLRB jurisdiction. No CBA executed. 5th Circuit appeal pending.
Decertified / Closed (formerly organized)	1	0.7%	International High School of New Orleans — NLRB cert 2016; employer refused to bargain 2016-2025; school closed 2025. 10 ULP cases. Extended refusal-to-bargain pattern documented.
Total Charter Schools in Louisiana	138	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 138 open LA charter schools as of May 2026). STATE_META charterUniverseTotal = 142 — see charterUniverseNote.

Charter School Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	93,239 students — 14.0% of state K–12 enrollment (666,840 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	43,742 students in network-affiliated schools — 46.9% of total charter enrollment
Students in Organized Charter Schools	3,615 students (3.9% of charter enrollment)
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
Charter Schools USA	EMO	6	25	—	8,202
Einstein Charter Schools	EMO	3	—	—	1,018
KIPP New Orleans	CMO	8	—	—	6,144
Collegiate Academies	CMO	6	—	—	3,037
Community School for Apprenticeship Learning	CMO	5	—	—	3,882
GEO Academies	CMO	4	—	—	2,054

ReNEW Schools	CMO	4	—	—	2,491
Edward Hynes Charter Schools	CMO	3	—	—	1,757
JCFA	CMO	3	—	—	337
FirstLine Schools	CMO	3	—	—	2,075
Louisiana Key Academy	CMO	3	—	—	717
Young Audiences Charter Schools	CMO	3	—	—	2,230
Audubon Charter Schools	CMO	2	—	—	1,385
Ochsner Discovery Health Sciences	Network‡	3	—	—	3,310
Redesign Schools Louisiana	Network‡	3	—	—	849
Helix Schools	Network‡	3	—	—	1,014
BASIS Educational Group	Network‡	2	—	—	1,311
Lake Charles Charter Academy Foundation	Network‡	2	—	—	1,575
NET Charter High Schools	Network‡	2	—	—	354
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Louisiana		68		—	43,742
of which organized				—	—

Total enrollment shown is the combined enrollment of all CMO/EMO network schools in Louisiana. Organized network schools: 0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters.

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

2 EMO (for-profit), 11 CMO (nonprofit), 6 network (type unclassified). Approximately 71 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Charter School Overview

Findings are based on research as of May 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

Louisiana Employee Relations Act (LERA) — post-Act 172 (signed May 23, 2024) for all BESE-authorized Type 2/5 charters. Pre-Act 172: NLRA / NLRB R15. Locally-authorized (Type 1/3/3B/4) charters: LSCSC/LERA throughout. Louisiana is a right-to-work state (La. R.S. §23:982). Charter schools in Louisiana are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (LSCSC / NLRB R15). Card-check recognition is available under Voluntary recognition (board vote) has been the dominant mechanism in the NOLA charter school community. No card-check statute per se — but board vote recognition produces the same outcome without an adversarial election. LSCSC/LERA does not have an established charter school certification procedure as of May 2026..

2: Charter School Structure

Louisiana operates 139 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 93,239 students. 19 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Louisiana, including 2 for-profit EMOs. The largest networks by campus count are KIPP New Orleans (8 campuses in state), Collegiate Academies (6 campuses in state), Charter Schools USA (6 campuses in state). Approximately 71 schools

operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Press coverage of LA charter school labor relations is concentrated in The Lens NOLA (local investigative outlet) and Verite News, which have covered UTNO organizing campaigns with substantive reporting. The Hechinger Report provided the foundational early coverage of Morris Jeff's 2013 organizing as a national test case. The Lycée Français Act 172 case received Verite News coverage in February 2026 (the most recent significant piece in the dataset). National charter school community press has not followed Louisiana closely relative to Illinois, New York, and California.

Stakeholder Communications

UTNO maintains an active web presence (utno.org) with CBA links for organized schools. AFT Local 527 is the formal filing entity for NLRB cases. UTNO President Dave Cash is publicly identified. Adams and Reese LLP (Brooke Duncan) is the documented defense counsel for Act 172 and Lycée Français jurisdictional challenge. No employer-side press communications identified defending their anti-union posture publicly.

Authorizer & State Agency Positions

BESE (authorizer of Type 2/5 schools) has not publicly addressed charter school labor relations separately from Act 172 implementation. OPSB (authorizer of Type 1/3/3B/4 schools) authorized the schools where voluntary recognition occurred — no evidence of OPSB opposition to those recognitions.

Coalition & Advocacy Positions

Louisiana Association of Public Charter Schools (LAPCS) is the statewide charter advocacy voice. No LAPCS public statements on unionization identified. New Schools for New Orleans (NSNO) is the major charter school community funder in NOLA — no public statements on labor relations identified.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

LSCSC / NLRB R15 public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may require a records request for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
Morris Jeff Community School	Morris Jeff United Educators (MJUE) / UTNO AFT Local 527	CONFIRMED Active — successive contracts since 2013	UTNO website / Research accumulator source link
Benjamin Franklin High School	United Teachers of Franklin / UTNO AFT Local 527	CONFIRMED Active — successive contracts since 2014	UTNO website / Research accumulator source link
Bricolage Academy	Bricolage Academy Educators United (BAEU) / UTNO AFT Local 527	CONFIRMED Active — since 2021 election win	UTNO website / Research accumulator source link
Lycée Français de la Nouvelle-Orléans	Union des Educateurs du LFNO (UELFNO) / UTNO	NONE — jurisdiction stripped by Act 172 N/A	N/A
International High School of New Orleans	United Teachers of International High	NONE — employer refused to bargain	N/A

(CLOSED)	School / UTNO	2016–2025 N/A	
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